

Question 1. Estimate the error if $P_3(x) = 1 + x + \frac{x^2}{2} + \frac{x^3}{6}$ is used to estimate the value of $f(x) = \frac{\sin x}{e^x}$ by fill in the blanks below.

1. By Taylor's theorem, for each x , the error is

$$R_3(x) = f(x) - P_3(x) = \frac{f^{(4)}(c)}{4!} x^4 = \frac{e^c}{24} x^4$$

for some c in between 0 and x .

2. Noting that $|c| \leq |x|$, the error is bounded by (fill in a number)

$$|R_3(x)| \leq \frac{1}{24} e^{|x|} |x|^4.$$

3. If we were to consider all x in $(-1, 1)$, an upper bound for the error is (fill in a number)

$$|R_3(x)| \leq \frac{1}{8} \quad \text{using } e^{|x|} \leq 3 \quad |x|^4 \leq 1$$

(or $\frac{e}{24}$)

4. In general, if we were to consider all x in $(-a, a)$, an upper bound for the error is

$$|R_3(x)| \leq \frac{1}{24} e^a a^4$$

depending on the value of a .

If we want to find an interval $(-\frac{1}{N}, \frac{1}{N})$ such that the error is less than 0.001, we need to solve the inequality

$$|R_3(x)| \leq \frac{e^{1/N}}{24} \frac{1}{N^4} < 0.001,$$

so one possible value of N is 10. (feel free to be wasteful!)

Question 2. Calculate an upper bound for the error if the following $P_n(x)$ is used to estimate $f(x)$ on $(-0.1, 0.1)$. Moreover, find an interval $(-a, a)$ such that the error is less than 0.001.

a) $P_1(x) = 1 + \frac{x}{2}$ for $f(x) = \sqrt{1+x}$

$$f'(x) = \frac{1}{2(1+x)^{1/2}} \quad f''(x) = -\frac{1}{4(1+x)^{3/2}}$$

$$|R_1(x)| \leq \frac{1}{8(1+c)^{3/2}} |x|^2$$

$$\text{For } c \text{ and } x \text{ in } (-0.1, 0.1), |R_1(x)| \leq \frac{0.01}{4} = 0.0025$$

For c and x in $(-0.1, 0.1)$, $\frac{1}{(1+c)^{3/2}} \leq 2$.
We can use $a=0.01$, then we still have $\frac{1}{(1+c)^{3/2}} \leq 2$.

$$\text{So } |R_1(x)| \leq \frac{0.01^2}{4} \leq 0.001$$

c) $P_2(x) = x + x^2$ for $f(x) = \sin(x)e^x$

$$f^{(3)}(x) = (\sin(x) + 3\cos(x) - 3\sin(x) - \cos(x))e^x$$

$$= (-2\sin(x) + 2\cos(x))e^x$$

$$|R_2(x)| \leq \frac{4e^{|x|}}{6} |x|^3$$

$$\text{For } x \text{ in } (-0.1, 0.1), |R_2(x)| \leq 2 \cdot 0.1^3 = 0.002$$

We can use $a=0.01$,
then we still have $e^{|x|} \leq 3$,
using $e^{|x|} \leq 3$.

$$\text{So } |R_2(x)| \leq 2 \cdot 0.01^3 \leq 0.001.$$

b) $P_4(x) = x - \frac{x^3}{6}$ for $f(x) = \sin(x)$

(this P_4 is indeed a fourth-degree approximation of $\sin(x)$)

$$f^{(5)}(x) = \cos x$$

$$|R_4(x)| \leq \frac{1}{120} \frac{|\cos c|}{120} |x|^5 \leq \frac{|x|^5}{120}$$

$$\text{For } x \text{ and } c \text{ in } (-0.1, 0.1), |R_4(x)| \leq \frac{0.1^5}{120}$$

$$\text{Because } \frac{0.1^5}{120} < 0.001, a=0.1 \text{ already works.}$$

d) $P_3(x) = \frac{x^3}{3}$ for $f(x) = \int_0^x \sin(t^2) dt$

$$\text{Note } f(x) = \int_0^x \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n t^{4n+2}}{(2n+1)!} dt = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n x^{4n+3}}{(4n+3)(2n+1)!}$$

For all x , this is alternating, so

$$|R_3(x)| = \left| \sum_{n=1}^{\infty} \frac{(-1)^n x^{4n+3}}{(4n+3)(2n+1)!} \right| \leq \frac{|x|^7}{42}$$

$$\text{When } x \text{ is in } (-0.1, 0.1), |R_3(x)| \leq \frac{0.1^7}{42}$$

$$\text{We can just use } a=0.1 \text{ because } \frac{0.1^7}{42} < 0.001$$